



FIRST SEMESTER 2026-27
COURSE HANDOUT

Date: 01.08.2026

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Timetable), this portion gives further details regarding the course.

Course No : GS F245
Course Title : *Effective Public Speaking*
Instructor-in-Charge : PUSHP LATA
Manasi Panwar (RS)
Apoorv Kumar (RS)

1. Course Description

Goals of Public Speaking, differences and similarities between Public Speaking and General Purpose Speaking, Role of Critical Thinking in Successful Public Speaking, Speaker's Credibility; Different phases of Nervousness, dealing with Nervousness; Non- Verbal Communication, Using Body and Voice for communication, paralinguistic features; Using visual aids; Speech Writing and delivering- Effective Introductions and Conclusions; Speeches for Special Occasions; Team Presentations; Group Discussion and Job Interviews

2. Scope and Objectives of the Course

The course aims to familiarize students with the art of public speaking and help them become confident, ethical, and effective speakers in academic and professional contexts. Students will learn to manage public speaking anxiety, construct logical arguments, organize speeches, and deliver presentations using appropriate content, structure, language, paralinguistic features, kinesics, and visual aids.

The revised course also enables students to use AI-assisted tools in a limited and responsible manner for idea generation, outline development, rehearsal feedback, and slide improvement, without replacing independent thinking or original expression. Students will be encouraged to assess AI output critically for accuracy, audience suitability, bias, and ethical use.

3. Classroom Methodology

The classroom methodology includes lectures, group and pair work, practical activities, guided rehearsal, and performance-based tasks. The course remains strongly practice-oriented and develops speaking skills through JAMs, extempore speaking, storytelling, parliamentary debates, group discussions, interviews, and presentation tasks.

Video clips and model speeches will be used for illustration. In addition, selected classroom activities may include AI-supported speech brainstorming, AI-assisted audience adaptation tasks, and guided reflection on AI-generated feedback, while preserving the same teacher-led, practice-based format intact.

4. Text Books

TB 1: Lata, P., & Kumar, S. (2007). *Communicate or collapse: A handbook of effective public speaking, group discussion, and interviews*. Prentice Hall of India.

TB 2: Lucas, S. E., & Stob, P. (2020). *The art of public speaking*. McGraw-Hill.

TB 3: Penn State University Libraries. (2026). *Beyond the Podium: AI, Speech, and Civic Voice*. Open



educational resource integrating AI literacy into public speaking instruction. [psu](#)

Reference Books

Anderson, C. (2016). TED talks: The official TED guide to public speaking. Nicholas Brealey.
Davidson, J. (2006). The complete guide to public speaking. Manjul Books.
Duarte, N. (2010). Resonate: Present visual stories that transform audiences. Wiley.
Gallo, C. (2014). Talk like TED: The 9 public-speaking secrets of the world's top minds. St. Martin's Press.
Kumar, S., & Lata, P. (2015). Communication skills (2nd ed.). Oxford University Press.
Sedniev, A. (2012). Magic of public speaking: A complete system to become a world-class speaker. Asia-Pacific Holdings Private Limited.
Selected research readings on AI and public speaking pedagogy, including work on AI in public-speaking curricula, AI-based feedback, and delivery-focused AI activities.

5. Overall Learning Outcomes of the Course

Knowledge and Understanding

Having successfully completed the module, students should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- ✓ Basic components of public speaking.
- ✓ Reasons for and symptoms of stage fright, and ways to combat it.
- ✓ Steps involved in preparing outlines and organizing speeches.
- ✓ Different modes of delivery and the use of connective devices.
- ✓ Drafting different types of speeches.
- ✓ Basic principles of responsible AI use in speech preparation, practice, and review

Application of Knowledge and Skills

Having successfully completed the module, students should be able to:

- ✓ Plan, prepare, and deliver different types of speeches, JAMs, and presentations.
- ✓ Capture and maintain audience attention.
- ✓ Participate constructively and meaningfully in group discussions and parliamentary debates.
- ✓ Perform effectively in job interviews.
- ✓ Use AI tools selectively to brainstorm topics, refine outlines, rehearse delivery, and improve presentation design while retaining authorship and accountability

Communication Skills and Analytic Techniques

Having successfully completed the module, students should be able to:

- ✓ Listen effectively.
- ✓ Speak confidently.
- ✓ Demonstrate oratory skills.
- ✓ Use body language appropriately.



- ✓ Use vocalics effectively.
- ✓ Construct logical arguments and counter-arguments.
- ✓ Evaluate AI-generated speaking prompts, feedback, or scripts for relevance, bias, and communicative effectiveness

General Transferable Skills

Having successfully completed the module, students should be able to:

- Maintain good personal and professional relationships.
- Critically assess their own speaking and that of others.
- Develop good argumentative skills.

Demonstrate ethical digital literacy in the use of AI-supported communication tools

6. Course Plan

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference Chap/Sec.	Learning Outcomes
1 & 2	Public Speaking: An Overview	TB 1: 1; TB 2: 1	Familiarity with the fundamental concepts, perspectives, and goals of public speaking.
3 & 4	Critical Thinking	TB 1: 2; TB 2: 1 & 17	Recognize the role of critical thinking in successful public speaking and understand speaker credibility; distinguish between original thinking and AI-generated assistance
5 & 6	Combating Nervousness	TB 1: 2; TB 2: 1	Understand symptoms and phases of nervousness, and learn strategies such as breathing and rehearsal; use guided AI rehearsal or feedback tools cautiously for practice support
7 & 8	Using Body and Voice to Communicate	TB 1: 4; TB 2: 13	Learn the importance of non-verbal communication, gesture, posture, facial expression, pace, pitch, articulation, and voice modulation for impactful delivery.
9	Using Wit and Humor	TB 1: 14 (Reading Assignment)	Understand audience-sensitive and context-appropriate use of humor



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10 & 11	Storytelling	Reading material to be provided in class	Develop narration, voice modulation, and expressive speaking style; explore how AI can assist with idea prompts without replacing speaker authenticity
12	Mock	To be announced in class	Storytelling practice
13-15	Evaluation	To be announced in class	Storytelling: evaluative component and feedback
16 & 17	Speech Preparation and Gathering Material	TB 2: 5, 7, 8 & 9	Determine speech purpose, locate material, identify delivery modes, organize ideas, and use connective devices; practice using AI for brainstorming and outline generation with verification of facts and sources
18	Using Visual Aids	TB 2: 14	Understand different types of visual aids, use of technology, and principles of presenting with visual aids; learn to improve slide planning with AI support while maintaining accuracy, simplicity, and attribution
19 & 20	Analyzing the Audience	TB 1: 6; TB 2: 6	Understand audience dynamics, interaction patterns, diversity, and complexities such as ethnocentrism and sexism; examine how AI may misread audiences or reproduce bias
21 & 22	Preparing an Outline	TB 1: 7; TB 2: 11	Understand the importance and process of creating preparation, topic, and speaking outlines; compare self-developed and AI-assisted outlines critically
23 & 24	Crafting Introduction and Conclusion	TB 1: 10; TB 2: 10	Use attention getters, stories, statistics, analogies, quotations, and questions effectively; draft emphatic conclusions and avoid formulaic AI-generated openings unless revised critically
25 & 26	Speeches for Special Occasions	TB 1: 11; TB 2: 18	Learn forms such as welcome, introduction, felicitation, farewell, commemorative speech, eulogy, and keynote address



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27-29	Speeches for Evaluation	To be announced in class	Prepare and deliver original speeches
30	Parliamentary Debate	YouTube and reference material to be given in class	Learn proposition strategy, rebuttal, case division, and points of information; learn to use AI for preparatory idea mapping
31	Mock	To be announced in class	Parliamentary debate practice
32-34	Evaluative	To be announced in class	Parliamentary debate
35 & 36	Group Discussion	TB 1: 17; TB 2: 20	Understand the nature, types, and significance of group discussion, evaluation criteria, and opening/closing strategies, building arguments, supporting evidence, and structuring counter-argument,
37 & 38	Participating in Job Interviews	TB 1: 16	Learn employer perspectives, preparation strategies, first impressions, and answering techniques; use AI to rehearse probable interview questions ethically and selectively
39-41	Evaluative	To be announced in class	Group discussion
42	Revision Classes		Review the entire syllabus and discuss the comprehensive exam pattern

7. Evaluation Scheme

Component	Duration	Weight age (%)	Date & Time	Nature of component (Close Book/ Open Book)
Mid-Semester Test	90 Min.	30 %	06/10/2026 AN1	CB



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Comprehensive Examination	2 hrs.	30 %	TBA	OB/CB
Class Assignments (5) (Presentation and Participation)	Will be announced in the class	35 %	07/12/26 FN	CB/OB
Attendance		05 %		

Class hour and room M W F 8 6151

Chamber Consultation Hour: Monday 9th hr

8. Notices: Nalanda

9. Make-up Policy: Make Up- subject to prior permission.

10. Closed Book Test: No reference material of any kind will be permitted inside the exam hall.

Open Book Exam: Use of any printed /written reference material (books and notebooks) will be permitted inside the examination hall. Loose sheets of paper will not be permitted. No exchange of material will be allowed.

Instructor-in-charge
Course No. GS F245



List of Speeches and talks for listening audios and watching videos

1. 2003 World Champion of Public Speaking, Jim Key: <https://youtu.be/54Ck5V495dA>
2. https://www.ted.com/talks/nancy_duarte_the_secret_structure_of_great_talks/up-next?language=en
3. 2013 Women in the World Summit - April 5, 2013, delivered by Hillary Rodham Clinton at **Women in the World Summit**
4. **Change Your Closet, Change Your Life | Gillian Dunn | TEDxWhiteRock**,
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WiVHSRY2I5Y>
5. J.K. Rowling Speaks at Harvard Commencement- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wHGqp8lz36c>
6. Steve Jobs' 2005 Stanford Commencement Address (with intro by President John Hennessy)-
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UF8uR6Z6KLc>
7. The Speech that Made Obama President - **Obama's 2004 DNC keynote speech-**
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ueMNqdB1QIE>
8. The Youth Parliament Debate - Politics Debate - Part 1 and Part 2-
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YCJA8-8DIk>
9. Original Speech - Swami Vivekananda Chicago Speech In Hindi Original | Full Lenght | Uncut Speech-
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cdTy8e7XMxA>
10. I have nothing to offer but blood, sweat, toil and tears – Winston Churchill, 13th May 1940.
11. A Tryst with destiny – Jawaharlal Nehru, August 14th 1947
12. An Idea for which I am prepared to die – Nelson Mandela. April 20th 1964
13. Free at Last – Nelson Mandela – 2 May 1994
14. Ain't I a Woman? – Sojourner Truth 1851
15. The Winds of Change Harold MacMillan – February 3rd 1960.
16. Winston Churchill We shall fight on the beaches 1940
17. Martin Luther King I Have a Dream 1963
18. Address at the World Parliament of Religions – Swami Vivekananda
19. Quit India speech – Mahatma Gandhi
20. Narayana Murthy's Speech at Lal Bahadur Shastri Institute of Management on the role of Western values in contemporary Indian society
21. I have a dream – Rahul Bose as a key-note speaker at the annual event at BITS Pilani
22. My Vision For India – Abdul Kalam
23. Aung San Suu Kyi, 'Freedom From Fear' (1990)
24. Maya Angelou, 'On the Pulse of Morning' (1993)
25. Quest for Universalism in Globalization and Human Imagination by Shashi Tharoor